



MOUNTAIN WEATHER, TOLD STRAIGHT.

SNOWY MOUNTAINS, AU · WINTER 2026 OUTLOOK

What it feelzlike for winter in the Snowies.

It is shaping up as a proper winter. After two thin years, the long-range models are pointing to a colder, wetter season across the Main Range, with the storm track sitting further north than usual. Opening weekend looks more ceremonial than skiable, but a run of southerly fronts from late June should put the season on its feet. By the time school holidays start, this should feel like the winter the Snowies has been waiting for.

THE SEASON AT A GLANCE

JUNE

The slow start

Opening weekend on 7 June will be cold and clear, with cover thin and mostly machine-made. The first real fronts arrive mid-month, dusting the high country above 1,500m. Patient skiers only.

JULY

When it lands

School holidays bookend the busiest fortnight of the year, and the modelling is on side. Three to four cold fronts are likely, with bases climbing to 90-120cm by month's end. Book early or stay flexible.

AUGUST

The deep month

Historically the heaviest snow falls of the year. Long-range guidance shows storm cycles every five to seven days, with crowds well off their July peak. The connoisseur's month.

SEPTEMBER

Spring lap

Warm afternoons, soft corn, long runs in T-shirts. Lower elevations turn patchy by mid-month, but the high country usually holds until closing weekend on 4-5 October.

JULY SPOTLIGHT

July: when the Snowies stops pretending.

If only one month of this winter goes to plan, let it be this one. Current modelling has three to four cold fronts working their way across the range, with the biggest stretch landing in week two. Resort bases should sit between 70 and 110cm for most of the month, and the village of Jindabyne is already 80% booked for the week of 6 July. The pattern matters because, in good Julys, the Snowies skis as well as anywhere in the southern hemisphere. In bad ones, it doesn't ski at all. This one looks like the former.

WED 1 TO SUN 5 JUL

The calm before.

A high parks itself over the range and refuses to budge. Mornings start at -8°C at 1,800m and warm to bluebird, with snow-making humming through the night. The terrain is limited but the conditions are flattering, which is to say: an excellent week to put the kids in lessons or relearn what edges feel like.

New snow

5-10cm machine, no natural

Crowds

Light, pre-holidays

Best for

Lessons, groomers, families

MON 6 TO SUN 12 JUL

The week everything turns.

School holidays open with a roar. The first serious front of the season rolls in late Thursday and parks over the range into Friday, dropping 25 to 40cm across Perisher and Thredbo before clearing for what should be a Saturday powder day for the ages. The catch: every other skier in the country has the same plan. Book parking now, not on the morning.

New snow	30-45cm Thu to Fri
Crowds	Heavy, school holidays
Best for	Powder Saturday, all-mountain

MON 13 TO SUN 19 JUL

The locals' favourite.

A second front sweeps through Tuesday into Wednesday, laying down another 15 to 25cm on top of the previous week's haul. Cold air sticks around. Midweek is the sweet spot: every lift open, fresh snow underfoot, and the school-holiday throng thinning enough that lift queues become bearable again.

New snow	20-30cm Tue to Wed
Crowds	Heavy weekend, easing midweek
Best for	Backcountry tours, all-mountain

MON 20 TO FRI 31 JUL

The quiet finish.

School holidays end and the resorts breathe out. Long-range models point to two more fronts, around 22-23 July and again on 28-29 July, which should push bases to their seasonal peak of 110 to 130cm. Locals call this the best value fortnight of the year: full snow, half the people, and warmer afternoons that make it easy to stay out until the lifts close.

New snow	20-35cm across the fortnight
Crowds	Quiet weekdays
Best for	Value, fresh tracks, longer days

MOUNTAIN BY MOUNTAIN

Perisher

Opens Sat 7 Jun

70-110cm by late July

The biggest resort in the country and the easiest place to lose a friend for an afternoon. Front Valley and Smiggins open first; Blue Cow and Guthega follow once the cover holds.

Thredbo

Opens Sat 7 Jun

75-115cm by late July

Australia's highest lifted terrain, and the only resort here that consistently offers true top-to-bottom skiing in early July. Steeper, longer, and a touch wilder than Perisher.

Selwyn

Opens Sat 14 Jun (planned)

30-50cm by late July

Smaller, lower, and built for families. The post-fire rebuild brought in serious snow-making, but it remains a weekday-only proposition outside the holidays.

Charlotte's Pass

Opens Sat 14 Jun

60-100cm by late July

The highest village in Australia, reached by snow-cat from Perisher Valley. Quiet, slightly old-world, and home to some of the most reliable snow in the range.

HOW WE FORECAST

How we built this read.

This outlook blends the Bureau of Meteorology's official seasonal guidance with snowpack data from Snowy Hydro, the resorts' own opening plans, and our own pattern-matching against the last fifteen Snowies winters. We do not run our own climate model. What we do is read the same public sources every serious snow watcher reads, then write the result in plain English. Where a number is a target, not a measurement, we say so. Where the modelling is uncertain, we say that too. Treat the week-by-week breakdown as a probable shape of the season, not a daily forecast. For that, check the alerts page in the week of travel.

SOURCES

Bureau of Meteorology long-range outlook	Temperature and rainfall trend across the Australian Alps for Jun-Sep
Snowy Hydro snow depth records	Historical baseline for Spencers Creek snow depth, used to gauge whether the season is tracking above or below average
Perisher and Thredbo snow reports	Stated opening dates, lift status, snow-making capacity
Mountainwatch model guidance	Short and medium-range storm tracking for the Main Range
Transport for NSW alpine road conditions	Chain rules, road closures, and overnight ice warnings on the Alpine Way and Kosciuszko Road
Destination NSW accommodation availability	Aggregate room availability for Jindabyne, Thredbo Village and Charlotte's Pass

Numbers in this preview are sample figures used to illustrate format. Production sends will carry the latest values from the sources above.

PLAN AHEAD

Lift passes

Multi-day passes are cheaper before 30 June. After that, prices step up sharply through the holidays.

Accommodation

Jindabyne and Thredbo village are already 80% booked for the week of 6 July. Berridale and Cooma still have rooms.

Driving

Carry chains from 1 June. The Alpine Way closes overnight when temperatures crash, and the road from Berridale ices up before sunrise.

Backcountry

Avalanche risk briefings begin on 1 July on the alerts page. If you're heading off-piste, read them.

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